

VUEKUMI / VUEQUATRO

Admin Portal & Country Activation Engineering Implementation Specification

Version 1.2 • September 2026 • Engineering / Product / Trust & Safety / Legal review

Status: implementation proposal. Supersedes the brief scope of document 21 in the v1.1 legal suite only for engineering detail; it does not replace legal agreements, local legal sign-off, or the existing Country Activation Matrix.

Operating perimeter: African-resident/eligible contributors; global buyers; invited people and copyright owners may verify rights without obtaining a contributor account or meeting Africa-only contributor eligibility.

Executive build decision

Build ONE versioned policy-decision service powering eight connected admin modules. Never let country settings exist only in a spreadsheet, client-side dropdown or editable Boolean. Every contributor registration, invitation, image-publication, licensing and payout decision must call the appropriate backend gate and return a policy version and reason codes.

1. Rules the implementation must preserve

Rule	Required behavior
Africa-only contributor account	Only verified applicants meeting the final Africa-based eligibility definition and an ACTIVE role-specific country policy may obtain contributor privileges. Birthplace, ethnicity or photo appearance do not prove eligibility.
Global buyers	Worldwide buyer onboarding does not consult the Africa-only contributor gate. It has distinct payment, sanctions, consumer/privacy and market-of-use checks.
Nonmember rights holders	An invited model or copyright owner anywhere may review and authorize particular images through a restricted nonmember path, subject to applicable jurisdiction and identity-processing checks.
Two distinct rights	Photographer/copyright authorization and each required person's likeness release are independent records. ID/facial verification never grants a license or proves copyright ownership.
Compensation negotiation	A model may condition a new release on negotiated payment; no mutual signed terms means no commercial unlock for that proposed arrangement.
No retroactive erasure	Country suspension or later rights disputes block operations as specified; they do not silently revoke valid historical buyer licenses or delete audit/release evidence.
Fail closed	A missing, stale, conflicting, expired or inaccessible required policy decision blocks the regulated action; preserve access to reporting, appeals, existing-account data and authorized payments as law permits.

2. Modules and screens the team should implement

Module	Admin screens / key actions
A. Countries	List, country detail, 16-gate checklist, source/evidence review, version comparison, reviewer assignment, scoped feature toggles, activation/suspension wizard and scheduled review alerts.
B. People & eligibility	Contributor applications, verified residence/business base, roles, invited nonmember rights holders, identity-verification result, status-change history, re-verification and restricted profile access.
C. Assets & rights	Asset queue, AI screening flags, detected subjects, copyright claim, model-per-subject release, rights ledger, manual-review queue, license preview and independent reason-coded commercial lock.
D. Consent & negotiation	Invite rights holder, restricted image preview, identity step, rights scope, percentage/fixed-fee proposals, counteroffers, signature/version capture, allocation calculator and payout-beneficiary binding.
E. Complaints & enforcement	Public report intake, DMCA queue/counter-notice deadlines, likeness/safety queue, asset holds, evidence vault, repeat-infringer assessment, appeal workflow and notification history.
F. Payouts / tax	Payee onboarding (including nonmembers), tax form/validity flags, source/characterization decision, sanctions and provider checks, revenue ledger, splits, holds, withholding and reconciliation.
G. Work / approvals	Assignable cases, four-eyes review, RBAC, effective-date scheduler, separation-of-duties checks, SLA timers, escalation and administrative override management.
H. Audit / monitoring	Append-only event view, country-policy diffs, rules-engine trace, compliance documents, failed gate metrics, privacy request tracking, alerts and exportable country activation dossier.

3. Country configuration: canonical model

Keep an ISO 3166-1 alpha-2 country record plus a versioned country policy. The 54-country source matrix imports as HOLD; research notes are NOT evidence that a country has passed legal review. Do not treat one ACTIVE flag as permission for all activities.

Field	Type / principle
iso2, iso3, display_name	Immutable country identifier; name and source provenance recorded.
geo_contributor_eligible	Whether country is on current Africa-based geographic list; separate from operational launch status.
policy_status	HOLD / REVIEW / ACTIVE / SUSPENDED / OFFBOARDING; status of country policy, not blanket permission for every service.
policy_version, effective_from/to	Immutable approved snapshot; scheduled activation/expiration; no backdating.
feature_scope	Per-action ON/HOLD/CONDITIONAL configuration: contributor_signup, contributor_upload, new_license, payouts, biometric_match, minor_program, nonmember_consent.
role_scope	Photographer, model, photo influencer and future approved contributor roles can vary by country.

Field	Type / principle
evidence and reviewers	Source URLs + access dates + file checksums, legal reviewer, specialist signoffs, second approver, review due date and reason.
provider readiness	Identity vendor coverage; government-ID country support; permitted retention; payout rail/currency; tax processing; sanctions screening.
suspension effects	Explicit treatment of NEW signup, NEW upload, NEW licenses, pending consent, historical licenses and earned but unpaid balances.

4. Sixteen mandatory country review gates

- 01 Scope/business model and local counsel assignment
- 02 Copyright ownership, commissioning and assignment
- 03 Likeness, privacy/publicity and model release
- 04 E-signatures and admissible consent evidence
- 05 Data-protection law and extraterritorial reach
- 06 Required registrations, local representative and permits
- 07 International data transfers / U.S. hosting
- 08 Government-ID checks: law and vendor availability
- 09 Facial/biometric verification: lawful basis and deletion
- 10 Minors, guardians and child compensation
- 11 Tax characterization, withholding and reporting
- 12 Payment rails, currencies and local licensing
- 13 Sanctions, beneficial ownership and payment restrictions
- 14 Complaints, consumer, accessibility and language needs
- 15 Retention, security and incident response
- 16 Final contracts, approved SOP, counsel + operational sign-off

Per gate: NOT_STARTED → RESEARCHING → BLOCKED / APPROVED / NOT_APPLICABLE. “Not applicable” requires written rationale and a distinct approver. A gate may be reopened; its prior version remains audit-visible. A source note or unreviewed hyperlink is not APPROVED evidence.

5. Country activation lifecycle

State	Required conditions / effect
HOLD	Default import, country awaiting assessment. New contributor onboarding blocked.
REVIEW	Research and evidence collection; no automatic marketplace privileges.
ACTIVE	All required gates approved / approved not-applicable, not stale; provider tests pass; counsel + independent activation approval; exact policy version published.
SUSPENDED	New actions restricted per reasoned scope; previously issued licenses preserved as records; balances and existing-account access receive separate risk review.
OFFBOARDING	Controlled closure with notices, lawful payout decisions, data retention/deletion schedule and preserved legal records.

Activation must be transactional: lock the policy version, recheck every gate and reviewer independence, issue a single immutable activation event and refresh the policy-decision cache. No direct database edit to the country status is an authorized activation path.

6. Staff permission model and four-eyes controls

Role	Can do	Cannot do
Researcher	Draft country findings; attach sources and open review tasks.	Approve own gate or activate country.
Jurisdiction counsel	Approve country-specific legal interpretation and legal gate evidence.	Unilaterally activate or replace specialist signoff.
Privacy / ID / Tax / Payments / T&S leads	Approve assigned specialist gates and vendor controls.	Approve outside assigned specialty by default.
Compliance administrator	Confirm package completeness; submit activation request.	Be sole activation approver where also preparer.
Independent authorizer	Review activation dossier and approve effective policy.	Self-approve own prior material changes.
Security administrator	Manage staff access, keys and break-glass response.	Use technical access to bypass legal activation rules.
Support investigator	View only case-relevant restricted information and execute delegated holds.	Access raw IDs/face templates or approve country legality.

Require MFA for admins, least-privilege authorization at backend routes, maker-checker approvals, access logs, time-limited break-glass actions with independent review, and a privacy-preserving audit trail (store identifiers/references rather than raw ID images).

7. User journeys and required backend gates

7.1 Contributor onboarding

1. Applicant selects a photographer/model role and provides country-of-residence or creator-business-base information; optionally joins waitlist if not active.
2. Eligibility service checks geographic list + country policy ACTIVE + role allowed + feature signup ON; never infer geography solely from IP, passport nationality, name or appearance.
3. Identity provider verifies document and residence evidence as designed; save result token, not raw biometric templates in country registry.
4. Tax, sanctions, payment reachability and account terms are evaluated for the appropriate step; incomplete payout onboarding may allow limited portfolio features if separately permitted.
5. Create contributor account only after affirmative acceptance and all required admission gates; keep underlying policy/version and verified residence evidence reference.

7.2 Photographer uploads image featuring model

6. Accept draft upload to private quarantine; run person detection and rights screening.
7. Photographer asserts copyright authority; list each discernible subject.
8. For every subject, obtain applicable release or send restricted invitation to named contact; do not create an account for that contact.
9. Invitee elects nonmember consent or contributor registration (separate choices), completes applicable ID/face match, and separately grants/rejects the specific rights.
10. If model conditions release on revenue share, run negotiation and bind signed payment agreement to relevant images, dates and license classes.
11. Recheck all rights plus country policy immediately before listing and before each NEW commercial license.

7.3 Model uploads photograph made by photographer

12. Model confirms own likeness authorization and gives photographer/copyright-owner information.
13. VueKumi verifies copyright grant or assignment and its scope; model ID is not evidence that the model owns copyright.
14. Any other recognizable people separately undergo appropriate release clearance.
15. If required revenue/license terms remain unsigned, keep commercial status LOCKED.

7.4 Nonmember outside Africa

Allow an invited model in Canada, a copyright owner in the U.S., or another foreign rights holder to use a restricted consent workflow without Africa-based contributor access. Where compensation is due, create a restricted PAYEE profile after independent tax, sanctions, identity, provider and local-law checks. This must not automatically activate a contributor profile.

7.5 Country suspension, rights disputes and outstanding balances

Distinguish suspension reason and action scope. Pause new licenses when legally indicated. Keep an append-only history of issued licenses and previously accepted release terms. Freeze disputed revenue only under documented contractual/lawful conditions; route already-earned funds through separate payout/legal review. Provide case access and notice to affected users where safe and permitted.

8. Rights ledger, negotiations and commercial unlock

The asset service needs independently versioned rows for copyright grants, people/subject detections, likeness releases, negotiation and financial entitlements. A “VERIFIED USER” badge is not sufficient to unlock an image.

Object	Essential fields / behavior
Asset	asset_id, uploader, source-country policy version, creation metadata claims, AI analysis version, current availability and independent hold reasons.
Copyright right	owner identity, authority basis, permitted acts/territory/term/sublicense/AI exclusions, signed document hash, review state.
Subject/right holder	subject_id, asset mapping, invite ID, identity-match outcome reference, release terms/version and withdrawal/dispute history.
Negotiation	proposal/counterproposal ID, party IDs, status, image set, type (flat/%/hybrid), denominator, term, taxes, revocation effect and signatures.
License snapshot	license_id, buyer, allowed uses/territory/term, image rights-policy version and payment allocation version effective at sale.
Payee split	gross receipts, platform fee, refunds, eligible contributor pool, each payee's contractual rate/amount, tax withholding and final remittance.

Commercial eligibility formula: allowed_by_country_and_program AND valid_copyright_license AND every_required_likeness_release_valid AND all_necessary_payments/negotiation_terms_satisfied AND no_active_legal_or_safety_hold AND product/license-specific market checks pass. Deny with explicit machine-readable reason codes, not a generic Boolean.

9. Suggested backend architecture

Service	Responsibilities
Policy Decision Service (PDS)	Single backend evaluator for actor + action + country/role/asset/payee + time + version; issues ALLOW/DENY/REVIEW with reason codes and evidence requirements.
Jurisdiction Policy Store	Versioned policy, 16 gates, linked evidence, approvers, scoped effective dates; emits changes to PDS.
Identity & Invitation	ID provider integration, invitation tokens, nonmember sessions, optional account conversion; ephemeral biometric data and vendor deletion attestations.
Rights & Asset Service	Asset quarantine, person-screening output, individual consent/copyright grants, negotiated terms and commercial locks.
License & Billing	Pre-issue rights recheck, immutable buyer license snapshot, quote and licensed-use context; reconciliation with payment ledger.
Tax / Payout	Payee type, documentation, source/type analysis, required withholding, sanctions/provider checks, balance controls and reconciliation.
Case & Audit	DMCA/likeness/safety complaint queues, evidence links, deadlines, enforcement history, append-only events and sensitive-data access logs.

The PDS must be server-side and called by the actual registration, asset-listing, license-issuance and payout APIs. Client UI hiding a button is never the enforcement control. Cache only signed/versioned decisions with short expiry and explicit invalidation after HOLD/SUSPENDED changes; DENY if authoritative policy cannot be verified.

10. Minimum database entities

country, country_policy_version, country_gate, gate_evidence, gate_approval, country_feature_scope, country_transition, admin_role_assignment, audit_event, identity_verification, residence_verification, contributor_profile, rights_holder (including nonmember), rights_invitation, asset, detected_subject, copyright_grant, likeness_release, rights_hold, negotiation_thread, signed_revenue_agreement, buyer_license_snapshot, payee_profile, payout_instruction, compliance_case and enforcement_event.

Use foreign keys and immutable IDs for traceability; encrypt PII in dedicated systems with scoped retention. Do not place government-ID scans, raw face templates, broad photo copies or personal phone/email fields inside a country-policy table or a freely exportable admin report.

11. Suggested internal API contracts

Endpoint	Contract / enforcement
GET /admin/countries; GET /admin/countries/{iso2}	Paginated overview and versioned country record; RBAC, rate limit, redacted evidence summaries.
PATCH /admin/countries/{iso2}/gates/{gate_id}	Draft/review only; version precondition, evidence references, actor and immutable audit event.
POST /admin/countries/{iso2}/submit-review	Check completeness; create independent approval task.
POST /admin/countries/{iso2}/activate	Recheck 16 gates, reviewer independence, provider readiness and signed policy version; schedule or atomically publish.
POST /admin/countries/{iso2}/suspend	Reason + scope + effective time + incident/ticket + required notifications and downstream cache invalidation.
POST /policy/evaluate	Input actor_id, action, country context, role, optional asset/payee/buyer/license-use, event_time; output ALLOW/DENY/REVIEW, reason_codes, policy_version, expires_at.
POST /rights/invitations; POST /rights/consents	Short-lived invitation, verified session, versioned document and image-set authorization; no implied account creation.
POST /assets/{id}/commercialize; POST /licenses	Run authoritative policy/rights check in transaction before commercial listing or license issuance.
POST /payouts/{id}/authorize	Recheck rightful payee, source/type, tax docs/withholding, provider support, sanctions and disputed holds.

All write calls: authenticated RBAC, idempotency key, optimistic version/ETag, reason/ticket, encrypted request transport, structured errors and append-only audit. Never expose raw ID photos or face-match inputs in normal API logs.

12. Admin interface wireframe inventory

Screen	UI controls / visible detail
Country overview	Search, filter by HOLD/REVIEW/ACTIVE/SUSPENDED, role, due date and blocking gate; tile counts and alert banner. No one-click “activate all”.
Country detail	Legal owner, active policy version, 16 gates with evidence links and freshness, 7 feature scopes, payment/ID provider status, timeline, review date and activation dossier.
Gate review	Issue summary, applicable law/source, reviewer notes, evidence files, security classification, N/A rationale, ask-specialist / approve / block with reason.
Activation wizard	Diff vs prior policy, integration-test results, unresolved blockers, required signoffs, effective time, rollback plan and second-approver confirmation.
Contributor review	Verified residence proof status, role, country-policy decision/version, sanctions/provider issues and account restrictions; no broad raw-ID previews.
Rights case	Asset and redacted image preview, all subjects, copyright grant, consent requests, negotiation status, holds, who may act next and exact unlock reason codes.
Complaint case	Claim category, received time, notices and deadlines, evidence version, asset hold, priority, DMCA counter-notice state and repeat-infringer indicators.
Revenue review	Signed deal, split denominator, allocation validation, withholding class, payee country/provider readiness, payout holds and reconciliation.

13. Events and monitoring

Publish policy_approved, country_activated, country_suspended, review_expired, contributor_country_changed, identity_verified, model_consent_granted/rejected, negotiation_signed, rights_disputed, asset_commercial_locked/unlocked, license_issued and payout_released as typed events with correlation ID and policy-version linkage. Consumers must be idempotent and must recheck current policy for future-sensitive actions.

Monitor false approvals, unreviewed expirations, policy-cache mismatches, invitations sent to wrong contact, ID vendor retention/deletion failures, failed split allocations, licensing attempts against held content, late complaints and attempted admin self-approval. Alert a defined on-call owner; record investigation ticket and corrective action.

14. Delivery order and acceptance criteria

Delivery tranche	What must ship / acceptance evidence
P0: policy core	54-country HOLD import, PDS, country detail, 16 gates, RBAC/dual approval, signed version activation, contributor signup enforcement, nonmember route independence, audit log and expiry alerts.
P1: rights and revenue	Asset quarantine, AI subject flags, reciprocal invitations, ID/face-match provider flow, individual releases, negotiation and split validation, recheck before licensing.
P2: global operations	Complaint/enforcement queues, tax/payee/payout controls, buyer-market overlays, country suspend/offboard workflow, vendor deletion evidence, monitoring and operations reporting.

If existing VueKumi already has asset, account or payout services, integrate with their actual interfaces; do not rebuild working services solely to match these conceptual service names. No tranche is production-ready without its cross-system security and legal acceptance tests.

15. Mandatory test scenarios for QA/UAT

- Every country initially HOLD: no African contributor can self-activate from an unreviewed matrix row.
- ACTIVE Nigeria photographer + Canada nonmember model + Japan buyer: consent and licensing can proceed if all relevant non-country gates pass.
- Canada applicant attempts contributor account: deny contributor eligibility while still allowing a restricted invited model consent flow.
- One of sixteen required gates missing, stale or BLOCKED: activation fails with gate-specific reasons.
- Same staff member prepares and independently approves country: server denies with separation-of-duties reason.
- Admin directly changes database Boolean without approved policy event: PDS refuses policy as invalid.
- Suspension between image listing and checkout: new license recheck blocks issuance, existing license remains in audit/history.
- Photographer claims model release but model denies it: asset new commercial licensing stays locked; investigation opened.
- Model requests revenue share, photographer counters, no signed agreement: rights remain pending, payout allocation not generated.
- Two models plus photographer request shares summing above available pool: signing/activation blocked.
- Face-match false negative: manual appeal route without automatically fabricating identity consent; no biometric artifact leaks into logs.
- Verification vendor fails to delete template within configured window: vendor/privacy incident and feature safety flag raised.
- Invited person accepts release but declines account: no marketing/contributor profile created.
- Payee subject to tax/sanctions/provider restriction: separate payout review without erasing earned entitlement.
- DMCA counter-notice cannot automatically remove a separate likeness/safety hold.
- Backend unavailable or cache stale: policy-dependent write actions fail closed with traceable error and retry path.

16. Decisions owner must approve before engineering finalizes schemas

- Confirm legal entity acting as platform operator, license grantor and payment counterparty (VueKumi / VueQuattro naming).
- Confirm precise Africa-only eligibility definition (verified residence vs principal creator-business base), evidence requirements, exceptions and review cadence.

- Choose initial launch countries (none are legally cleared merely by appearing in the 54-country matrix).
- Choose ID/facial-verification vendor and signed data-processing/deletion contract; define human fallback and jurisdiction restrictions.
- Confirm buyer licensing product types and exactly which model use classes require extra consent.
- Confirm contributor revenue base, model negotiation mechanics, payout timing, refunds and tax specialist's classification rules.
- Confirm admin staffing: jurisdiction counsel, privacy lead, trust/safety lead, tax/payments lead and second approver.
- Confirm complaint SLAs, emergency response, retention schedules and incident escalation contacts.

Launch condition: run a jurisdiction-by-jurisdiction counsel and vendor validation against the actual deployed product, not merely this document. This engineering specification does not itself approve any country or guarantee legal compliance.